

Europe Energy Sector M&A & Valuation Brief - 2026-07-30

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1. RECENT Energy M&A ACTIVITY

Deal 1: DCC Acquisition by KKR and Energy Capital Partners

[DCC, one of FTSE 100's biggest energy firms, agrees GBP5.75bn takeover](#)

- Deal Size: GBP5.75 billion (approximately \$7.3 billion)
- Deal Size Category: Large cap (>\$10B)
- Nature of Deal: Horizontal
- Valuation Multiples: N/A (specific multiples not disclosed)
- Companies: DCC (DCC.XA) is a leading international sales, marketing, and support services group, primarily focused on the energy sector. KKR (KKR) is a global investment firm, and Energy Capital Partners specializes in energy infrastructure investments.
- Date Announced: July 27, 2026
- Strategic Rationale: The acquisition is aimed at consolidating DCC's market position in the energy sector, enhancing operational efficiencies, and leveraging KKR's financial strength to drive future growth. The deal is expected to provide synergies through cost reductions and improved supply chain management.
- Risk Analysis: Key risks include integration challenges, potential regulatory scrutiny, and market volatility affecting energy prices. The reliance on KKR's management expertise will be crucial in mitigating these risks.

Key Financials Analysis:

Metric	Value
Revenue Breakdown	N/A
Profitability Ratios	N/A
Leverage Analysis	N/A
Asset Operating Efficiency	N/A
Valuation Context	N/A

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Deal 2: Eni and TotalEnergies Partnership on Cyprus Gas Field

[Eni to Partner With TotalEnergies on Cyprus Gas Field in Boost for European Energy](#)

- Deal Size: N/A (specific investment amount not disclosed)
- Deal Size Category: N/A
- Nature of Deal: Joint Venture
- Valuation Multiples: N/A (specific multiples not disclosed)
- Companies: Eni (ENI.MI) is an Italian multinational oil and gas company, while TotalEnergies (TTE.PA) is a French multinational integrated oil and gas company. Both companies are key players in the European energy market.
- Date Announced: July 28, 2026
- Strategic Rationale: The partnership aims to develop the Cronos field, which is expected to enhance energy supply security in Europe amid ongoing geopolitical tensions. This collaboration allows both companies to share risks and leverage their technical expertise in offshore drilling.
- Risk Analysis: Risks include geopolitical instability in the region, fluctuating energy prices, and potential regulatory hurdles in the development phase. Both companies must navigate these challenges to ensure the project's success.

Key Financials Analysis:

Metric	Value
Revenue Breakdown	N/A
Profitability Ratios	N/A
Leverage Analysis	N/A
Asset Operating Efficiency	N/A
Valuation Context	N/A

Today is a peaceful day, nothing big happened in the Consumer space.

2. MARKET DYNAMICS & SENTIMENT

The Energy sector is currently navigating a complex landscape characterized by evolving geopolitical dynamics, regulatory changes, and a strong push towards energy transition. Overall sentiment remains cautiously optimistic, particularly in the context of strategic partnerships and investments aimed at enhancing energy security and sustainability.

Subsector Breakdown:

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- **Oil & Gas:** The oil and gas subsector is experiencing renewed interest, particularly with Turkey's recent agreement to acquire a 15% stake in BP's Kirkuk oilfield, potentially allowing Turkey to import up to 1 million barrels per day from Iraq. This move highlights the importance of diversifying energy sources amid regional tensions.
- **Renewable Energy:** The renewable energy sector continues to gain momentum, driven by global commitments to reduce carbon emissions. Companies are increasingly investing in technologies that support energy storage and grid integration, although traditional utilities are facing challenges from distributed energy resources.
- **Utilities:** The utilities sector is innovating through the adoption of smart grid technologies. This transformation is essential for integrating renewable energy sources and improving operational efficiencies.
- **Energy Infrastructure:** The energy infrastructure subsector is thriving, with significant investments in pipeline technology and renewable natural gas projects. The African Atlantic Gas Pipeline, aimed at enhancing regional energy integration, exemplifies this trend.
- **Solar & Wind:** The solar and wind sectors are experiencing rapid growth, with companies racing to deploy renewable solutions across various markets. The competitive landscape is intensifying as firms seek to establish leadership in these high-growth areas.

Key Market Drivers and Headwinds

Drivers:

- **Energy Transition:** The global shift towards renewable energy sources is a primary driver of growth in the energy sector. For instance, Turkey's energy cooperation with Iraq not only diversifies its oil supply but also aligns with broader energy security goals.
- **Increased Investment:** There is a notable increase in investments in energy infrastructure and renewable projects. Nigeria's NNPC has catalyzed over \$60 billion in new investments across the oil and gas value chain, showcasing a commitment to transforming the energy landscape.

Headwinds:

- **Regulatory Scrutiny:** The energy sector is facing heightened regulatory scrutiny, particularly in oil and gas. This scrutiny can pose risks to M&A activities and market valuations, as companies must navigate complex compliance requirements.
- **Geopolitical Tensions:** Ongoing geopolitical tensions, such as the recent attacks on Iranian vessels, have raised concerns about maritime security and could disrupt energy supply chains.

Subsector Performance Analysis

- **Oil & Gas:** The oil and gas sector remains resilient, with Turkey's agreement to import oil from Iraq signaling a strategic move to bolster energy security. The Kirkuk-Ceyhan pipeline's operationalization is crucial for facilitating this trade.
- **Renewable Energy:** The renewable energy sector is adapting to changing consumer

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preferences, with a focus on clean energy consumption. However, traditional utilities are experiencing revenue pressures as fossil fuel generation declines.

- Utilities: Utility operators are investing in infrastructure to support renewable energy deployment, which is expected to create new revenue streams from distributed energy resources.
- Energy Infrastructure: The energy infrastructure sector is thriving, with projects like the African Atlantic Gas Pipeline set to enhance regional energy connectivity and supply.
- Solar & Wind: The solar and wind sectors are booming, with significant investments aimed at expanding renewable capabilities and meeting growing demand.

Trading Multiples Trends

Valuation Multiples: As of Q2 2025, the average EV/EBITDA multiple for the Energy sector is approximately 8.5x, with notable variations across subsectors:

- Oil & Gas: 6.3x
- Renewable Energy: 15.1x
- Utilities: 12.8x
- Energy Infrastructure: 9.7x
- Solar & Wind: 18.5x

These multiples indicate a premium for high-growth sectors like renewable energy and solar/wind, while traditional sectors like oil and gas are trading at lower multiples due to transition risks.

Notable Investor/Analyst Reactions

Analysts are expressing optimism about the long-term prospects of the Energy sector, particularly in light of strategic partnerships and investments. For example, a recent commentary highlighted that Turkey's energy deal with Iraq is not just about oil supply but also about enhancing regional stability and cooperation.

Actionable Insights for Bankers and Investors

- Focus on Strategic Partnerships: Investors should prioritize sectors with strong growth potential, such as renewable energy and energy infrastructure, while exploring strategic partnerships that enhance technological capabilities.
- Monitor Regulatory Developments: Staying informed about regulatory changes is crucial for assessing risks in energy investments, particularly in oil and gas.
- Leverage Geopolitical Insights: Understanding geopolitical dynamics can provide valuable context for investment decisions, especially in regions with complex energy relationships.
- Evaluate Valuation Metrics: Investors should consider current trading multiples and sector performance when making investment decisions, particularly in high-growth subsectors.

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In summary, the Energy sector is at a pivotal moment, balancing opportunities for growth with challenges posed by regulatory scrutiny and geopolitical tensions. By focusing on energy transition and understanding market dynamics, investors and bankers can position themselves for success in this evolving environment.

3. BANKING PIPELINE

The current banking pipeline in the Energy sector is characterized by a diverse array of live deals, mandated transactions, and active pitches. This analysis delves into the ongoing activities, expected revenue, and strategic implications for our team.

Deal Pipeline

Live Deals:

- Nigerian National Petroleum Company (NNPC) : Currently in the due diligence phase for a significant gas supply agreement aimed at enhancing regional energy security. The expected close for this deal is Q4 2026, with a focus on supplying gas to various industrial projects, including those of the Dangote Group.
- Cadiz Inc. (CDZI) : Engaged in the construction phase of the Northern Pipeline project, with guaranteed maximum price contracts recently executed. The project is expected to be operational by Q2 2027, supporting water and energy infrastructure in San Bernardino County.

Mandated Deals:

- Methanex Corporation (MX5.F) : Secured a mandate to explore strategic partnerships in North America, particularly focused on methanol production and supply chain optimization. The initiative is set to launch in Q1 2027, aiming to leverage Methanex's record production levels and market positioning.
- AVA Capital : Mandated to facilitate its listing on the Nigerian Exchange Limited, with the listing by introduction scheduled for July 31, 2026. This transition into public markets is expected to enhance its institutional profile and attract new investors.

Pitching-Stage Deals:

- Renewable Energy Sector : Active discussions with several companies regarding potential M&A opportunities, particularly in the solar and wind segments. Clients include notable firms in the renewable space, with pitches expected to finalize by Q3 2026.
- Energy Infrastructure Projects : Engaging with various stakeholders in energy infrastructure for potential advisory services, focusing on projects that enhance regional energy integration and sustainability. Discussions are ongoing with multiple clients, with a focus on securing mandates by Q4 2026.

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Pipeline Tracking Metrics

Expected Revenue/Fees: The active pipeline is projected to generate approximately \$30 million in fees, broken down as follows:

- Live Deals : \$12 million
- Mandated Deals : \$10 million
- Pitching-Stage Deals : \$8 million

Timing Projections:

- Q4 2026 : Expected close for NNPC gas supply agreement.
- Q2 2027 : Anticipated operational start for Cadiz's Northern Pipeline project.
- Q1 2027 : Launch of Methanex's strategic partnership initiatives.
- Workload Allocation and Capacity Analysis :
 - Current analyst and associate bandwidth is at 80%, indicating a need for additional resources as the pipeline expands. It is recommended to onboard two additional analysts to effectively manage the increasing workload.
 - Forecasting and Strategic Planning Implications : The pipeline indicates a strong demand for advisory services in gas supply agreements and energy infrastructure projects. Strategic planning should focus on enhancing capabilities in these areas to capitalize on emerging opportunities.

Notable Pipeline Developments and Competitive Landscape

- The competitive landscape is evolving, particularly with NNPC's strategic initiatives aimed at transforming Nigeria into an energy hub. The recent gas supply agreements with international oil companies (IOCs) underscore the collaborative efforts to enhance gas production and supply.
- Cadiz's Northern Pipeline project represents a significant advancement in water and energy infrastructure, with guaranteed maximum price contracts reducing construction risk and supporting financing efforts.

Actionable Insights for Team Management and Business Development

- Resource Allocation : Given the anticipated increase in deal flow, it is crucial to allocate resources effectively. Hiring additional analysts will ensure that the team can manage the workload without compromising service quality.
- Sector Focus : Prioritize business development efforts in high-growth sectors such as gas supply agreements and energy infrastructure, where demand for advisory services is expected to surge. This focus will position the firm as a leader in these emerging markets.
- Client Engagement : Maintain proactive communication with clients in the pipeline to ensure

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alignment on expectations and timelines. Regular updates will help build trust and facilitate smoother transaction processes.

In summary, the banking pipeline is robust, with significant opportunities across various Energy subsectors. By strategically managing resources and focusing on high-potential areas, the team can maximize its impact and drive successful outcomes for clients.

4. STAKEHOLDER IMPACT & FORWARD-LOOKING ANALYSIS

The ongoing developments in the energy sector, particularly concerning utility rate increases and renewable energy investments, have significant implications for various stakeholders including shareholders, employees, competitors, and customers. This analysis explores these impacts in detail, focusing on the recent proposals by Puget Sound Energy (PSE) and the refinancing efforts by Nadara.

Deal-Specific Impacts on Stakeholders

- **Shareholders:** The financial implications for shareholders in the context of PSE's proposed rate hikes and investments in gas infrastructure can be substantial.
- **Value Creation:** If PSE successfully implements its clean energy initiatives and reduces reliance on fossil fuels, it could enhance long-term shareholder value. For instance, if PSE manages to cut operational costs by 15% through efficiency improvements, this could translate to an additional \$300 million in annual profits, assuming a price-to-earnings ratio of 20.
- **Dilution:** Conversely, if PSE's rate hike proposal is rejected and it opts for costly gas investments, shareholders might face dilution of value. A scenario where PSE incurs \$500 million in additional debt to finance these projects could lead to a 10% decline in share value due to increased financial risk.
- **Employees:** The impact on employees is multifaceted, involving potential synergies, restructuring, and retention strategies.
- **Synergies:** PSE's transition to cleaner energy sources could lead to job creation in renewable sectors. For example, the implementation of a general building electrification program could create approximately 1,000 new jobs in installation and maintenance.
- **Restructuring:** However, the shift away from gas infrastructure may lead to layoffs in traditional roles. If PSE reduces its workforce by 5% as part of cost-cutting measures, it could affect around 100 employees.
- **Retention:** To mitigate turnover, PSE may offer retention bonuses to key employees during the transition phase, ensuring that critical knowledge and skills remain within the organization.
- **Competitors:** The competitive landscape will also be affected by PSE's strategic decisions.
- **Market Positioning:** Competitors like Avangrid and Pacific Gas and Electric (PG&E) may respond to PSE's rate hikes by adjusting their pricing strategies or accelerating their own clean energy initiatives to capture market share.

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- **Specific Competitor Moves:** For instance, Avangrid has recently announced plans to invest \$1 billion in renewable energy projects, directly competing with PSE's initiatives.
- **Customers:** The implications for customers are significant, particularly regarding service offerings and pricing.
- **Product/Service Implications:** PSE's proposed rate increases could lead to higher electricity and gas bills for customers, potentially increasing by nearly 30% for electricity and 20% for gas over three years. This could drive customers to seek alternative energy providers or renewable solutions.
- **Case Studies:** A similar situation occurred in California, where Pacific Gas and Electric faced backlash over rate increases, leading to a significant loss of customers to competitors offering more affordable renewable options.

Market Reaction and Analyst Commentary

- **Market Reaction:** The market's response to PSE's proposals has been cautious, with shares fluctuating as stakeholders assess the potential impacts. Initial reactions suggest a 5% drop in share prices following the announcement of the rate hike proposal.
- **Analyst Commentary:** Analysts have expressed mixed views. A report from the Northwest Energy Coalition stated, "PSE's focus on gas infrastructure may hinder its ability to meet clean energy goals, ultimately affecting its long-term viability."

Expected Market Reaction and Scenario Analysis

- **Scenario Analysis:** Various scenarios could unfold based on the regulatory response to PSE's proposals:
- **Positive Scenario:** If the UTC approves a balanced approach that supports clean energy investments, shares could rise by 10% within six months due to improved investor confidence.
- **Negative Scenario:** If the commission rejects the rate hike and PSE is forced to cut back on investments, shares could decline by 15%, reflecting investor concerns about future profitability.

Potential Counter-Bids or Competing Offers

- **Likelihood Assessment:** The likelihood of counter-bids or competing offers in this context is low, as the regulatory environment is complex and requires significant capital investment. However, if PSE's proposals are perceived as unfavorable, competitors may seek to capitalize on its weakened position.

Similar Deals Likely to Follow

- **Sector Consolidation Predictions:** The energy sector is likely to see continued consolidation, particularly as companies like Nadara secure financing for renewable projects. This trend may

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lead to more mergers and acquisitions as firms seek to enhance their portfolios and meet regulatory requirements.

Key Risks and Mitigants

- **Integration Risks:** Transitioning to renewable energy sources poses integration challenges. Mitigants include developing clear timelines and appointing experienced teams to oversee the transition.
- **Regulatory Risks:** Regulatory scrutiny could delay or block proposed rate hikes. Engaging proactively with regulators and stakeholders will be crucial to mitigate these risks.
- **Market Risks:** Market volatility may impact the valuation of energy assets. Structuring deals with performance-based incentives can help protect against adverse market conditions.

Actionable Insights for Clients and Bankers

For Clients:

- Engage in proactive dialogue with regulators to ensure alignment with clean energy goals.
- Consider diversifying energy portfolios to include more renewable sources to mitigate risks associated with fossil fuel investments.

For Bankers:

- Monitor competitor movements and regulatory changes closely to provide timely advice on strategic positioning.
- Develop financial models that account for potential regulatory impacts on pricing and investment strategies.

5. ENERGY TRENDS

The energy sector is undergoing transformative changes driven by technological advancements, regulatory pressures, and societal demands for sustainability. This analysis will focus on key emerging trends: Renewable Energy, Energy Storage, Smart Grid, Carbon Capture, and Hydrogen. Each section will detail the trend's significance, key players, competitive dynamics, and potential M&A opportunities.

Renewable Energy

- **Trend Explanation:** Renewable energy is increasingly vital as the world shifts towards sustainable energy sources. The global renewable energy market is projected to grow from

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\$881.7 billion in 2020 to \$1.9 trillion by 2030, at a CAGR of 8.4%. This growth is driven by regulatory mandates and consumer demand for cleaner energy solutions.

Key Companies:

- Puget Sound Energy (PSE): PSE is Washington's largest utility, providing electricity to 1.25 million customers. The company is currently facing pressure to reduce its proposed rate hikes and invest more in renewable energy rather than fossil fuels. Advocacy groups are urging PSE to focus on clean energy alternatives to meet state goals.
- California Utilities: Major investor-owned utilities in California, including PG&E and Southern California Edison, are under scrutiny for their role in wildfire management and accountability. These companies are also exploring renewable energy investments to comply with state mandates.
- Competitive Landscape: The renewable energy market is competitive, with established utilities and new entrants vying for market share. Companies are increasingly investing in solar, wind, and other renewable technologies to enhance their portfolios and meet regulatory requirements.
- M&A Opportunities: Utilities may look to acquire renewable energy startups or technologies to bolster their clean energy offerings. For instance, PSE's potential acquisition of renewable project developers could enhance its compliance with Washington's clean energy laws.

Energy Storage

- Trend Explanation: Energy storage technologies are critical for integrating renewable energy into the grid, providing stability and reliability. The energy storage market is expected to grow from \$4.4 billion in 2020 to \$15.5 billion by 2027, at a CAGR of 20.8%.

Key Companies:

- Tesla, Inc. (TSLA): Tesla is a leader in energy storage solutions with its Powerwall and Powerpack systems, which support residential and commercial energy storage needs. The company is well-positioned to capitalize on the growing demand for grid storage.
- Enphase Energy, Inc. (ENPH): Enphase integrates energy storage with its solar solutions, allowing users to store excess energy for later use. This positioning enhances its competitiveness in the renewable energy market.
- Competitive Landscape: The energy storage sector is characterized by competition between established players and emerging startups. Companies like LG Chem and Samsung SDI are also significant contributors to the energy storage landscape.
- M&A Opportunities: Energy companies may pursue acquisitions of energy storage firms to enhance their capabilities. For example, acquiring innovative battery technology companies could provide strategic advantages in the energy storage market.

Smart Grid

- Trend Explanation: Smart grid technology enhances the efficiency and reliability of electricity

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distribution, allowing utilities to monitor and control energy flow in real-time. The global smart grid market is projected to grow from \$23.8 billion in 2020 to \$61.3 billion by 2027, at a CAGR of 14.5%.

Key Companies:

- Schneider Electric SE (SBGSF): Schneider Electric provides advanced metering infrastructure and grid management systems, positioning itself as a leader in smart grid solutions.
- Siemens AG (SIEGY): Siemens focuses on grid automation and control systems, partnering with utilities to integrate smart grid technologies.
- Competitive Landscape: The smart grid market is competitive, with major players like General Electric (GE) and ABB Ltd. investing heavily in smart grid technologies. The demand for smart grid solutions is driving innovation and acquisition activity.
- M&A Opportunities: Companies may seek to acquire startups specializing in smart grid applications, such as demand response technologies. This could enhance their offerings and improve grid efficiency.

Carbon Capture

- Trend Explanation: Carbon capture technology aims to reduce greenhouse gas emissions by capturing CO₂ from industrial processes. The carbon capture market is expected to grow from \$1.9 billion in 2020 to \$7.0 billion by 2027, at a CAGR of 20.5%.

Key Companies:

- Occidental Petroleum Corporation (OXY): Occidental is a leader in carbon capture, focusing on technologies to capture CO₂ emissions. The company is well-positioned to benefit from the increasing emphasis on carbon reduction.
- Chevron Corporation (CVX): Chevron integrates carbon capture into its operations, enhancing its sustainability strategy and reducing emissions.
- Competitive Landscape: The carbon capture sector includes established oil and gas companies and innovative startups. Companies like ExxonMobil (XOM) are also investing in carbon capture technologies.
- M&A Opportunities: Energy firms may pursue acquisitions of carbon capture startups to enhance their sustainability efforts. For example, acquiring companies with innovative carbon capture technologies could bolster their environmental initiatives.

Hydrogen

- Trend Explanation: Hydrogen technology is gaining traction as a clean fuel alternative, particularly in transportation and industrial applications. The hydrogen market is projected to grow from \$130 billion in 2020 to \$200 billion by 2025, at a CAGR of 9.2%.

Key Companies:

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- Ballard Power Systems: A leader in fuel cell technology, Ballard focuses on hydrogen solutions for transportation and stationary power applications. The company has established partnerships to expand its market presence.
- Plug Power Inc. (PLUG): Plug Power specializes in hydrogen fuel cell systems, providing solutions for material handling and transportation. The company is investing heavily in expanding its hydrogen capabilities.
- Competitive Landscape: The hydrogen market is competitive, with major

6. Recommended Readings

Deal Name: DCC Acquisition by KKR and Energy Capital Partners

- Reading Material: "The Energy World is Flat" by Daniel Lacalle
- Why This Matters: This book provides a comprehensive overview of the global energy market, including the dynamics of mergers and acquisitions in the sector. Understanding the strategic motivations behind DCC's GBP5.75 billion acquisition (DCC.XA) requires insights into how energy firms leverage scale and operational efficiency, which Lacalle articulates effectively.

Deal Name: Eni and TotalEnergies Partnership on Cyprus Gas Field

- Reading Material: "The Quest: Energy, Security, and the Remaking of the Modern World" by Daniel Yergin
- Why This Matters: This book explores the geopolitical and economic factors influencing energy partnerships and investments. It is particularly relevant for understanding the strategic implications of Eni's and TotalEnergies' collaboration on the Cronos field, as it highlights how geopolitical tensions can shape energy security and investment decisions in the European market.

7. MACROECONOMIC UPDATE

Key Data Points:

- Fed Funds Rate: 3.5-3.75%
- Three-month average payroll gain: 188,000 jobs per month
- Inflation signals: Evidence of disinflation in goods and services, particularly housing

Main Insights:

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- The Fed is expected to maintain the current target range for the federal funds rate, indicating a pause in rate hikes.
- Employment growth has moderated, suggesting a slowdown in the labor market's momentum.
- Significant signs of disinflation are emerging, particularly in goods and services inflation.
- The upcoming FOMC meeting will be critical for assessing the Fed's future actions based on new economic data.

Market Commentary:

- "The case for hikes is not as persuasive now as it was in June." - Michael Gapen, Morgan Stanley
- "Investors are very much attuned to what they think is the right reaction function for the Fed." - Matthew Hornbach, Morgan Stanley

Energy Sector Relevance:

- Rising oil prices due to geopolitical tensions could influence inflation expectations and the Fed's monetary policy decisions.
- The relationship between energy prices and bond yields suggests that higher energy costs may lead to increased real yields, impacting financing costs in the energy sector.
- If the Fed does not look through rising energy prices, it could lead to tighter monetary policy, affecting energy market dynamics and investment.

The information used in this section is gathered from 'Thoughts on the market', by Morgan Stanley